

MODULE 00 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

AWS Certified Security – Specialty (SCS-C03)

A complete course: 39 teaching modules, 4 practice exams, 243 original questions.

EXAM SCS-C03 MODULES 43 RUNTIME ~9h 48m

Not a tour of services. A course built around **the decisions the exam actually asks you to make.**

The exam, in numbers

Questions	65 – 50 scored, 15 unscored and not identified
Time	170 minutes, plus 30 on request for non-native English speakers
Scoring	Scaled 100-1,000. Pass at 750. Compensatory
Question types	Multiple choice, multiple response, ordering, matching, case study
Price	\$300 USD
Guide version	Exam guide v1.0, published 26 March 2026

ON THE EXAM

Ordering, matching and case study questions are new since SCS-C02. Module 38 covers how to answer each of them.

The six domains

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	MODULES
1 – Detection	16%	1 to 6
2 – Incident Response	14%	7 to 11
3 – Infrastructure Security	18%	12 to 18
4 – Identity and Access Management	20%	19 to 25
5 – Data Protection	18%	26 to 31
6 – Security Foundations and Governance	14%	32 to 36

ON THE EXAM

Identity is the heaviest domain, up from 16% in SCS-C02. Domains 1 and 2 were rebuilt, not just reweighted.

How the course is built

- ◆ **39 teaching modules**, each ending with four worked scenarios and a six-point summary.
- ◆ **4 practice exams**, 80 questions, weighted to the real domain distribution. No question appears twice.
- ◆ **243 original questions**. Every scenario was written for this course – none is lifted from a question bank.
- ◆ Every wrong option carries an explanation of **why it is wrong**, because that is where the discriminator lives.
- ◆ Where AWS does not publish something, the course says so rather than inventing a rule.

ON THE EXAM

The answer key across all 43 modules is balanced to within one question per letter. There is no positional pattern to exploit.

One thing most material gets wrong

- ◆ **Four services in scope changed status around the C03 launch**, and the guide still names some of them.
- ◆ **Incident Manager** closed to new customers. **CodeGuru Security** discontinued. **Audit Manager** in maintenance mode. **Security Hub** split in two.
- ◆ Two defaults changed too – **root MFA became enforced**, and **SSE-C was disabled by default** on new buckets.
- ◆ Where guide and reality disagree, this course gives you **both**.
- ◆ Every dated finding carries its date. Module 39 collects them all.

ON THE EXAM

If you have studied from material published before mid-2025, some of what you learned is now wrong. That is worth knowing early.

The course map

BLOCK	MODULES	COVERS
Detection	1-6	CloudTrail, CloudWatch Logs, GuardDuty, service selection, Security Lake, missing logs
Incident Response	7-11	Runbooks, preparation, testing, containment and forensics, six worked compromises
Infrastructure	12-18	Edge, Firewall Manager, VPC controls, hybrid access, compute, scanning, generative AI
Identity	19-25	Policy evaluation, writing policies, roles, human and application identity, ABAC, diagnosis
Data Protection	26-31	KMS, rotation and key material, encryption at rest, retention, transit, secrets and masking
Governance	32-36	Organizations, compliance, the root user, deployment, architecture and review
Cross-cutting	37-39	Confusion pairs, exam mechanics, what changed from SCS-C02
Practice exams	40-43	80 questions, domain-weighted, with answer keys and domain scoring

ON THE EXAM

The modules are ordered to build on each other, and each is self-contained enough to revisit on its own.

How to use the worked scenarios

- ◆ **Pause when the scenario slide appears.** The built-in gap is deliberately not long enough.
- ◆ **Read the requirement before the options.** Find the discriminating clause first.
- ◆ **Commit to an answer out loud.** Recognising is not producing.
- ◆ **Read the wrong options too.** Half the teaching is in those explanations.
- ◆ Right answer, wrong reason, is a miss. It will not survive a rephrasing.

ON THE EXAM

Every scenario in this course has at least one decisive clause. Real exam questions are written the same way.

How to use the practice exams

- ◆ **Do not take them until you have finished the teaching modules.** They are calibration, not instruction.
- ◆ **Sit each one unpaused,** using only the built-in gap, and score it in one sitting.
- ◆ **Score by domain, not just total.** Three wrong in one domain matters far more than five spread evenly.
- ◆ **Consistently 16 of 20 or better across all four** is the signal that you are ready to book.
- ◆ For anything you miss, go back to the module rather than re-reading the answer.

ON THE EXAM

Sit them again a week later. The second attempt measures retention; the first only measures recognition.

What this course assumes

- ◆ You can read an IAM policy – **Effect, Action, Resource, Principal, Condition**.
- ◆ You know what a VPC, subnet, security group and route table are.
- ◆ Service names are familiar, even where the details are not.
- ◆ It does **not** assume an associate-level exam, though it helps.
- ◆ AWS suggests five years of security experience and two on AWS. A guide, not a gate.

ON THE EXAM

This is a specialty exam. It assumes the fundamentals and spends its time on the judgement.

A note on accuracy

- ◆ Everything factual here was checked against **AWS documentation, the exam guide, or AWS's own announcements** at the time of recording.
- ◆ **Dated claims carry their date**, so you can check whether they still hold.
- ◆ Where two AWS sources disagreed, the course says so and teaches the safe working assumption rather than picking one.
- ◆ AWS moves. Anything here dated within the last year is worth re-checking against the current documentation before you sit.
- ◆ The exam guide referenced throughout is **version 1.0, published 26 March 2026**.

ON THE EXAM

Check the AWS What's New feed and the current exam guide the week before you sit. It takes ten minutes.

Start here

- ◆ **Working straight through** is the intended path. The modules build on each other, and later ones reference earlier findings by number.
- ◆ **Short on time?** Domains 4 and 3 are 38% of the exam between them – modules 19 to 25 and 12 to 18.
- ◆ **Already studied for C02?** Watch module 39 first. It tells you what is no longer true.
- ◆ **Revising?** Module 37 is 40 confusion pairs in seven tables, and module 38 is exam technique.
- ◆ Next up: module 1, CloudTrail – the record of what happened, and the one log that is on by default.

ON THE EXAM

Good luck. Take the scenarios seriously and the exam will feel familiar rather than surprising.